

Topic 17A: Chirality
1. know that optical isomerism is a result of chirality in molecules with a single chiral centre
2. understand that optical isomerism results from chiral centre(s) in a molecule with asymmetric carbon atom(s) and that optical isomers are object and non-superimposable mirror images
3. know that optical activity is the ability of a single optical isomer to rotate the plane of polarisation of plane-polarised monochromatic light in molecules containing a single chiral centre
4. understand the nature of a racemic mixture
5. be able to use data on optical activity of reactants and products as evidence for S _N 1 and S _N 2 mechanisms